

Joshua Birk

TECHNOLOGY ADVOCATE · DEVELOPER RELATIONS · AI ADVOCACY

joshua.birk@gmail.com · 847-687-9839
linkedin.com/in/joshuabirk · Chicago, IL

New technology keeps showing up. The habit has been the same for thirty years: **learn it**, build something real with it, then **explain it to everyone else**.

THE PATTERN

- CGI** 1997
State Farm's first intranet + polling dashboard before AJAX had a name.
- REST** 2010-14
Evangelized Salesforce's shift to REST-first APIs – what it meant, what to build with it.
- IoT** 2014-15
Ran the Salesforce IoT Zone: demo stations and hands-on workshops for two years.
- AI+MCP** 2022-now
Keynotes and workshops on AI agents anchored in real builds – not slides about what AI might do someday.

CAREER

2010-now	Salesforce
2007-10	Model Metrics
2002-07	Crate & Barrel
1999-01	Organic
1997-99	State Farm

BY THE NUMBERS

30 YEARS IN SOFTWARE	16 YEARS AT SALESFORCE
66 DAYS: IDEA TO TRAILHEAD LAUNCH	Day 1 APP STORE – EXPENSE2GO, 2008
4 YEARS HOSTING THE DEVELOPER PODCAST	100s PODCAST EPISODES PRODUCED

SELECTED WORK

- ▶ **Trailhead prototype** – Built Medals in 2014 to solve a workshop problem. Became Project Trailhead 66 days later.
- ▶ **Expense2GO** – Lead developer. Launched July 10, 2008: the day the App Store opened.
- ▶ **Salesforce Developer Podcast** – Created, produced, and hosted 2019-2023. Sourced every guest personally.
- ▶ **Behind the AI** – Keynote: From Theory to Practice and In Between (Mile High Dreamin' 2025).
- ▶ **The Pool At Nowhere** – Closing keynote on mental health and anxiety (Forcelandia 2023).

TOOLKIT

DEVREL & ADVOCACY

- Public Speaking
- Workshop Design
- Podcast Production
- Technical Writing
- Conference Content
- Community Building

AI & AGENTFORCE

- Agentforce
- MCP
- Prompt Engineering
- LLM Integration
- RAG
- AI Adoption Strategy

SALESFORCE PLATFORM

- Apex
- LWC
- Flow
- Metadata API
- SQL
- Salesforce CLI

LANGUAGES

- JavaScript / TS
- Python
- Rust
- Java
- Perl
- Objective-C
- HTML / CSS

EDUCATION

Illinois Wesleyan University
B.A. Psychology & English
1992-1996

Crisis Line Operator, PATH
Bloomington-Normal, IL · 5 years

- SPOKEN AT
- Dreamforce
 - TDX
 - Agentforce World Tours
 - Mile High Dreamin'
 - Forcelandia
 - True North Dreamin'
 - Dreamin' In Data
 - DevOps Dreamin' London
 - Cactusforce
 - Midwest Dreamin'
 - Snowforce



[JOSHBIRK.GITHUB.IO/RESUME](https://joshbirk.github.io/resume)